Surface Tensions:

Documentation

“Olfactory Anxiety”

Jake Hayduk

40319759

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Anna Eyler

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I have chosen to model my incredibly handy audio interface. I have been using it for a long time now, and it felt right to connect with it in some new sort of way. I believe I was right in guessing that this model would be an appropriate amount of work for someone like me, who has never really tried to use Blender before this. The most challenging part of it was getting started, as there is no tutorial for me to follow for this type of object. I did, however, end up loosely following a video tutorial for a knob/dial (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7ztHuFtHbSM). After doing it more than once, I became much more comfortable using the checkered selection, and extruding and beveling on limited axes. I did end up using a loop cut once for separating the glass from the rest of the body, so I see how that can be very useful. I'm still wondering if there's a better way to cut into the same shape a bunch of times rather than have a million boolean modifiers on that shape. Regardless, it didn't seem to affect the performance much. I used a free rubber texture asset from Poly Haven to enhance the texture of the knobs, plugging the bump into the normals. In a similar vein, I used a noise node to add subtle texture to the otherwise smooth surface of the body. For extra realism, as if it were my own interface that I have been using for years, I added some surface imperfection textures to the node tree using texture coordinate and mapping nodes with a math node and connected it to the roughness on my principled BSDF to finish it off.

I wouldn't say that my conceptual model is shocking or surprising at first glance but it does represent the idea that I had in mind. This is an object that I have used as a medium through which I expressed many of my other artistic creations, so my first thought was that it is just one simple form of joyful creativity. However, other senses and emotions can creep up on you in ways that are overwhelmingly uncontrollable. My conceptual piece titled "Olfactory Anxiety"

explores how we can sometimes feel like a box that is complete with buttons and dials that are just too much to control all at once. I exemplified this by using new, more emotional names for the dials and senses for the inputs that are likely to trigger an anxiety response in numbers. I realize that I cannot always be in control of everything, and this overwhelming, anxiety object is the opposite of what I would have expected from it. I also changed the colour of the objects and added a bit of subsurface scattering to emulate the feeling of skin but not that exactly. I'm not sure if this will subvert other peoples' expectations, but it was the idea that finally stuck for me, and made me wonder, "What have I done to this object that I know so well?"